Enhanced contact investigation of the first 30 measles cases in Denden

Reported Sunday 1 November 2026. Data: *Inject: contact investigation, reported 1 Nov 2026* (`contact_investigation_2026-11-01.csv`, 66 rows). *Exercise material: fictional countries, simulated data.*

Denden's public health service traced the contacts of the first 30 notified measles cases in Denden. These are C000001-C000030 in the line list, tested from 11 September to 17 October. Every contact who could be named was tested, with or without symptoms. The file has one row for each contact who tested positive.

How the investigation was done

- **Contacts traced:** household members, kindergarten groups, school classes, colleagues at work, and fellow students on university courses.
- **Testing:** every contact had PCR and serology (IgM and IgG avidity), with or without symptoms.
- **Follow-up:** until 1 November, at least 15 days after each contact's last exposure to the index case.
- **Assume the tests are perfect:** every infected contact was found, and no one tested positive falsely.

The columns

column	meaning
`contact_id`	K001-K066, numbered by this investigation
`index_case_id`	the case the contact was traced from (`case_id` in the line list)
`setting`	where the contact was exposed: household, kindergarten, school, workplace or university
`age`	age in years
`vaccination_status`	2 doses, 1 dose, unvaccinated, or not offered (born before 1980), as in the line list
`symptoms`	yes, or no (positive PCR or serology only)
`symptom_onset_date`	blank if no symptoms
`hospitalised`	admitted to hospital by 1 November
`notified_case_id`	the contact's `case_id` if routine surveillance had notified them by 1 November; blank if only this investigation found them

Reading the file

- **All 30 index cases were investigated.** An index case with no positive contacts has no rows.
- **Each positive contact appears once**, under the index case judged to be the source.
- **Chains:** some notified contacts are among the 30 index cases themselves. For example, K002 is C000005, so C000005's own contacts are in the file too.
- **The line lists:** a contact notified after 25 October is only in the 1 November line list, not the phase 1 list. Positive contacts found only by this investigation have not been added to either.
- No contact had died by 1 November.

Not in the file

- **Contacts who tested negative.** The number of contacts tested is not reported.
- **Contacts in the community** (shops, public transport, events, leisure). They could not be named, so they were not traced.
- **The index cases themselves.** They are in the line list.